Pattern Headings: Military Services

H 1159

Patterns: *United States–Armed Forces*; *United States. Air Force*; *United States. Army*; *United States. Marine Corps*; *United States. Navy*

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A. Recent revisions

2026-03: Updated template. Clarified text. Separated general and form subdivisions. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

B. Types of headings covered by the pattern

This instruction sheet contains the free-floating subdivisions that may be used under headings for names of individual military services established as corporate bodies in the name authority file, including military organizations at the state or province level, such as national guards. Also included are subject headings formed using the free-floating subdivisions *__--Armed Forces__* and *__--National Guard__* under names of regions and countries, and the free-floating subdivision *__--Militia__* under names of places larger than cities, and headings established using *__--Armed Forces__* under names of international agencies having armed forces.

Examples:

Great Britain. Army

Italy. Marina

Germany. Kriegsmarine

Japan. Rikugun

Texas. National Guard

Soviet Union–Armed Forces

United States–National Guard

Ohio–Militia

United Nations–Armed Forces

Warsaw Treaty Organization–Armed Forces

C. Types of headings not covered

The category does not include names of subordinate organizational units lower than a branch of the armed forces, such as divisions, regiments, battalions, fleets, or squadrons. For instructions on assigning headings to histories of individual organizational units lower than a branch of the armed forces, see H 1995. Also excluded are names of government agencies responsible for the operation of individual military services, for example, ***United States. Navy Department***.

D. Conflicts

D.1. General rule

Any subdivision listed here can be used as a free-floating subdivision under any heading belonging to the category if it is appropriate and no conflict exists in the subject authority file. Although many of the subdivisions listed here are logically applicable to only one branch of military service, they have been treated in this list as free-floating under all branches provided there is no conflicting subdivision used under another branch. Such conflicts are identified in the subdivision lists below. Subject authority records may exist for headings employing variant phrases or subdivisions equivalent to subdivisions on this list.

D.2. LC practice

If an exceptional variant form is to be retained, make a UF reference from the equivalent free-floating subdivision form following the procedures in H 195 if the reference does not yet exist. Otherwise, submit a proposal to change the variant form along with all bibliographic records requiring correction following the procedures in H 193.

E. Establishing new subdivisions

Establish new subdivisions under *__United States--Armed Forces__* in all cases where it is possible to do so. If a subdivision is not logically appropriate under that heading, establish it under the pattern heading for the particular branch of military service needed for the work being cataloged. For example, if a new subdivision is required for a work on a particular air force and the subdivision cannot logically be established under *__United States--Armed Forces__*, establish it under *__United States. Air Force__*. If the topic of the proposed new subdivision is unique to the military services of countries other than the United States, and therefore cannot logically be established under any of the pattern headings, establish it under the specific heading required for the work being cataloged.

F. Combinations of subdivisions

F.1. Class of persons subdivisions

Subdivisions on this list representing classes of persons, for example, *__--Apprentices__*; *__--Nurses__*; *__--Officers__*, may be further subdivided, as appropriate, by subdivisions from the list of free-floating subdivisions used under classes of persons (H 1100).

F.2. Period subdivisions

The subdivisions *__--History__* and *__--Recruiting, enlistment, etc.__* may be further subdivided on a free-floating basis by subdivisions for wars or armed conflicts in which the military service took part. The subdivisions may be formed based on headings for wars established either directly under their names or as subdivisions under place names.

Examples

Great Britain. Royal Navy–History–Falkland Islands War, 1982

United States. Navy–History–Spanish-American War, 1898

France. Armée–History–Revolution, 1789-1799

Canada. Royal Canadian Navy–History–World War, 1939-1945

Assign an additional heading designating the war with appropriate topical or geographic subdivisions. For subdivisions used under names of individual wars, see H 1200.

G. Special provisions for corporate bodies

Several of the subdivisions listed below may be equivalent to a corporate body subheading. If the concept exists as a corporate body, assign a heading with the subdivision and assign an additional heading for the corporate body if the work discusses the corporate or organizational aspects of the body. For example, in Belgium the artillery is an organized unit represented by the corporate heading ***Belgium. Armée. Artillerie***. For works on the Belgian artillery, assign the heading ***Belgium. Armée**--**Artillery***. If appropriate, assign as an additional heading the name of the corporate body.

In some cases, the corporate heading may only be valid for certain time periods. For example, Canada united all military services into one organization in 1968. The corporate heading ***Canada. Canadian Armed Forces*** should be used only for the period after 1968 and only for discussions of the corporate or organizational aspects of the body. All works on the Canadian military services discussed collectively should be assigned the subject heading ***Canada**--**Armed Forces***, regardless of the time period covered.

H. List of topical subdivisions

A-B | C-D | E-F | G-H | I-L | M-N | O-Q | R-S | T-Z

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Accounting		
$x Aerial gunners		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x African American officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x African American troops		
$x African Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Aides		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Air police		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
		Use only under air forces; use ***--Shore patrol*** under navies; use *--**Military police*** under other military services.
$x Airborne troops		
$x Airborne troops $x Communication systems		
$x Airmen		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Ambulances		
$x Appointments and retirements		
$x Apprentices		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Appropriations and expenditures		
$x Archives		Use as a topical subdivision under military services for works about documents or historical records, including notes, correspondence, minutes, photographs, legal papers, etc., pertaining to those services.
$x Armored troops		
$x Artillery		For countries in which the artillery, cavalry, or infantry is an organized unit, assign the corporate body name heading as an additional heading for discussions of the corporate or organizational aspects of the body. See explanation in sec. G, above.
$x Artillery $x Drill and tactics		
$x Asian Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Aviation		
$x Aviation $x Ground support		Use as a topical subdivision under military services other than air forces. Under air forces, use the subdivision ***--Ground support***.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Aviation $x Job descriptions		Do not use under air forces. Use this subdivision combination as a topical subdivision under military services for summaries of the essential activities involved in the performance of jobs.
$x Aviation electronics technicians		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Aviation mechanics		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Aviation supplies and stores		
$x Awards		
$x Bandmasters		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Bands		
$x Barracks and quarters		
$x Barracks and quarters $x Furniture		
$x Biography $x Portraits		Use as a topical subdivision under military services for works about portraits of persons in those military services.
$x Boats		
$x Boatswains		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Boatswain's mates		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Boiler technicians		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Cavalry		For countries in which the artillery, cavalry, or infantry is an organized unit, assign the corporate body name heading as an additional heading for discussions of the corporate or organizational aspects of the body. See explanation in sec. G, above.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Cavalry $x Drill and tactics		
$x Chaplains		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons. Do not use under *__[place]--Armed Forces__*; use *__Military chaplains--[place]__*, instead.
$x Chaplain's assistants		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Civic action		
$x Civil functions		
$x Civilian employees		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Clerical work		
$x Collier service		
$x Colonial forces	Yes	Not established under any branch of the United States armed forces. Use only under the military services of countries having colonial forces, for example, *__Great Britain. Army--Colonial forces__*; *__Spain. Ejército--Colonial forces__*.
$x Combat sustainability		
$x Commando troops		
$x Commissariat		Do not use under navies; use *__--Provisioning__* under navies.
$x Communication systems		
$x Construction mechanics		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Cost control		
$x Coxswains		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Cruise, [date]		See H 1078 for instructions on dates in subdivisions for specific events.
$x Demobilization		
$x Dental care	Yes	

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Diaries		Use as a topical subdivision under military services for works about diaries of persons belonging to those services.
$x Drill and tactics		
$x Electric installations		
$x Electronic installations		
$x Electronic technicians		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Energy consumption		
$x Environmental aspects	Yes	
$x Equipment		
$x Equipment $x Quality control		
$x Examinations		
$x Facilities		
$x Facilities $x Law and legislation		See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Field service		
$x Finance		
$x Finance $x Law and legislation	No	See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Fire controlmen		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Firearms		
$x Firearms $x Markings		
$x Firemen		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Flags		
$x Flight officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Flight surgeons		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$z Foreign countries		Use as a geographic subdivision under military services.
$x Foreign service	Yes	
$x Fuel		
$x Gay people		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons. Do not use under *__[place]--Armed Forces__*; use *__Gay military personnel–[place]__*, instead.
$x General staff officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x German Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Ground support		Use only under air forces; use *__--Aviation--Ground support__* under other military services.
$x Guard duty		
$x Guided missile personnel		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Guided missile personnel $x Training of	Yes	
$x Guided missile personnel $x Training of $x Aids and devices		
$x Gunners		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Headquarters		
$x Hispanic Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x History		
$x History $y 16th century		
$x History $y 17th century		
$x History $y 18th century		
$x History $y 19th century		
$x History $y 20th century		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x History $y 21st century		
$x History $y Revolution, 1775-1783, [War of 1812, etc.]		The subdivision ***--History--Revolution, 1775-1783*** is not valid under ***United States. Army***. Use ***United States. Continental Army—History*** instead.
$x Honorific unit titles		
$x Hospital ships		
$x Ice breaking operations		
$x Indian troops		
$x Infantry		For countries in which the artillery, cavalry, or infantry is an organized unit, assign the corporate body name heading as an additional heading for discussions of the corporate or organizational aspects of the body. See explanation in sec. G, above.
$x Infantry $x Drill and tactics		
$x Information services		
$x Insignia		
$x Inspection	No	
$x Intelligence specialists		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Inventory control		
$x Irish Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Italian Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Japanese Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Job descriptions	Yes	Use as a topical subdivision under military for works about summaries of the essential activities involved in the performance of jobs.
$x Journalists	Yes	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Lawyers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Leaves and furloughs		
$x Machine gun drill and tactics		
$x Management		
$x Maneuvers		
$x Mascots		
$x Masters-at-arms		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Medals, badges, decorations, etc.		Do not use under *__[place]--Armed Forces__*; use *__Military decorations–[place]__* instead.
$x Medical care	Yes	
$x Medical care $x Law and legislation		See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Medical examinations	Yes	
$x Medical personnel		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Medical personnel $x Malpractice		
$x Medical supplies		
$x Medical technologists		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Messes		
$x Mexican Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Military capital		Do not use under *__[place]--Armed Forces__*; use *__Military capital--[place]__* instead.
$x Military construction operations		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Military construction operations $x Law and legislation		See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Military life		
$x Military police		Do not use under air forces or navies; use ***--Air police*** under air forces; use ***--Shore patrol*** under navies.
$x Military police $x Foreign auxiliaries		
$x Minorities		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Mobilization		
$x Motorcycle troops		
$x Mountain troops		
$x Musical groups		
$x Non-commissioned officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Nurses		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Occupational specialties		
$x Officer efficiency reports		
$x Officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Officers' clubs		
$x Officers on detached service		
$x Officials and employees		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons. Do not use under armies, navies, and other branches of the armed forces. Use only under ***[place]--Armed Forces*** and under names of government agencies responsible for the operation of individual military

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
		services, for example, *__United States. Department of the Army--Officials and employees__*.
$x On television		
$x Operating room technicians		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Operational readiness		
$x Operations other than war		
$x Optical instrument repairers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Ordnance and ordnance stores		
$x Ordnance and ordnance stores $x Effect of environment on	Yes	
$x Ordnance and ordnance stores $x Quality control		
$x Ordnance facilities		
$x Organization		
$x Painting of vessels		
$x Parachute troops		
$x Pay, allowances, etc.		
$x Pay, allowances, etc. $x Law and legislation		See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Personnel management		
$x Personnel management $x Law and legislation	Yes	See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Personnel records		
$x Petty officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Photographers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Physical training	Yes	

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Political activity	Yes	
$x Political-military affairs officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Postal clerks		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Postal service		
$x Prisons		
$x Procurement		
$x Promotions		
$x Provisioning		Use only under navies; use *--**Commissariat*** under other military services.
$x Public relations	Yes	
$x Radio installations		
$x Radiomen		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Records and correspondence		Use as a topical subdivision under military services for works about records of those organizations.
$x Recruiting, enlistment, etc.		
$x Recruiting, enlistment, etc. $x Law and legislation		See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Recruiting, enlistment, etc. $y Revolution, 1775-1783, [Spanish-American War, 1898, etc.]		The subdivision *--**Recruiting, enlistment, etc.--Revolution, 1775-1783*** is not valid under ***United States. Army***. Use ***United States. Continental Army--Recruiting, enlistment, etc.*** instead.
$x Regulations		Use as a topical subdivision under military services for works about regulations of those services.
$x Religious life		
$x Remount service		
$x Reorganization		
$x Reserve fleets		
$x Reserves		

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Reserves $x Pay, allowances, etc.		
$x Reserves $x Personnel records		
$x Reserves $x Promotions		
$x Robots		
$x Rum ration		
$x Safety measures		
$x Sanitary affairs		
$x Sea life		
$x Search and rescue operations	Yes	
$x Security measures	No	
$x Service clubs		
$x Service craft		
$x Shore patrol		Use only under navies; use *--**Air police*** under air forces; use *--**Military police*** under other military services.
$x Ski troops		
$x Small-boat service		
$x Social services		Do not use under ***[place]--Armed Forces***; use ***Military social work--[place]*** instead.
$x Songs and music		Use as a topical subdivision under military services for works about vocal or instrumental music about those services.
$x Songs and music $x History and criticism		
$x Sports		
$x Stability operations		
$x Staff corps		
$x Staffs		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Stewards		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Storekeepers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Submarine forces		
$x Supplies and stores		
$x Supplies and stores $x Law and legislation		See H 1154.5 for further subdivisions used under legal topics.
$x Supplies and stores $x Quality control		
$x Surgeons		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Surgeons $x Malpractice		
$x Swiss Americans		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Tactical aviation	Yes	
$x Target practice		
$x Test shooting		
$x Training administrators		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Transport of sick and wounded		
$x Transport service		
$x Transportation	No	
$x Trials of vessels		
$x Uniforms		
$x Unit cohesion		
$x Vocational guidance	Yes	
$x Wage fixing		
$x Warrant officers		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Watch duty		Use as a topical subdivision under individual navies.

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$x Weapons systems		
$x Women	No	See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.
$x Women's reserves		
$x Yeomen		See H 1100 for further subdivisions used under classes of persons.

I. List of form subdivisions

LC practice: In early 2025, the use of form subdivisions was phased out. Library of Congress catalogers assign Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT) to bring out the form(s) and/or genre(s) of the resource being cataloged. Therefore, the form subdivisions maintained on this list are not available for use by Library of Congress catalogers. Catalogers at institutions external to LC may use them as dictated by their own institutional policies.

A-C | D-G | H-M | N-R | S-Z

Subdivision	May Subd Geog	Notes
$v Archives		Use as a form subdivision under military services for collections of documents or historical records, including notes, correspondence, minutes, photographs, legal papers, etc., pertaining to those services.
$x Archives $v Microform catalogs		Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under military services.
$x Aviation $v Job descriptions		Do not use under air forces. Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under military services for summaries of the essential activities involved in the performance of jobs.
$v Biography		Use for collective biographies that include various categories of individuals associated with the military service, for example, a collective biography of the officers and enlisted personnel of a service. For

		biographies limited to a specific category of individuals associated with a military service, use *--**Biography*** under the specific subdivision, for example, *--**African Americans***; *--**Nurses***; *--**Officers***; etc.
$v Biography $v Portraits		Use as a form subdivision under military services for collections of portraits of persons in those military services.
$v Diaries		Use as a form subdivision under military services for diaries of persons belonging to those services.
$x Drill and tactics $v Handbooks, manuals, etc.		Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under military services.
$x Examinations $v Study guides		Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under military services for study guides for examinations for, by, or about those services.
$v Firing regulations		
$x History $v Chronology		Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under military services.
$v Job descriptions		Use as a form subdivision under military services for summaries of the essential activities involved in the performance of jobs.
$v Lists of vessels		
$v Non-commissioned officers' handbooks		
$v Officers' handbooks		
$v Order-books		
$v Petty officers' handbooks		
$v Records and correspondence		Use as a form subdivision under military services for collections of records of those organizations.
$v Registers		
$v Registers of dead	No	
$v Regulations		Use as a form subdivision under military services for collections of regulations of those services.
$v Sailors' handbooks		

$v Songs and music		Use as a form subdivision under military services for collections or single works of vocal or instrumental music about the services.
$x Songs and music $v Discography		Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under military services.
$v Songs and music $v Texts		Use as a form subdivision under military services for texts of songs about those subjects.

Revision history

2025-08: Updated template. Clarified text. Separated general and form subdivisions. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.